



The Perfect Living Room

Check out this list of gadgets that should be a part of your living room to make it just perfect! <http://digit.in/PerfLR>



'Bedtime Mode' in Phones

Experts say that a 'Bedtime Mode' is what needs to be added to phones immediately to fix our sleep <http://digit.in/BedtmMode>

Time to re-accessorise

Agent001 shuffles through his accessory cabinet to see if anything needs replacing

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The need to replace your tools is an ancient dilemma. Even our ancestors who lived in caves would have had to grab hold of new flintstones every now and then as their older set wore out. It was either that or going back to rubbing sticks together and very few know how painful and time consuming that is. Life in today's world can be characterised similarly. You can either go about working with power tools and be able to focus your energy on coming up with innovative solutions or stick with hand tools and cancel that gym membership. For me, my tools are quite important and it's about time that I made a few well deserved additions.

When I'd purchased my Dremel 300, there were few stores that sold it and this was before the era of convenient online shopping. So as my drill bits wore out, and my cutting wheels turned into buffing wheels, I was forced to resort to jugaad to make do. I'd repurpose stainless steel nails with their heads chopped off as drill bits and superglue new sheets of emery paper onto my sanding wheels to keep the magic alive. So as I was browsing through various e-commerce portals looking for replacements one comment caught my eye. It'd mentioned a competing brand by the name of Proxxon. To satiate my curiosity I started digging deeper in order to compare the two products. Both are semi-professional drill/grinders and boast of a wide array of accessories to complement the main tool. Proxxon doesn't market their tools as well as Dremel does and navigating through their website to look for a particular tool isn't exactly a walk in the park.



Coming to the main tool, it turns out that Proxxon's drills are actually quite good. You can vary its RPM like you can with the Dremel but it isn't as noisy as the Dremel! If you've spent an eternity grinding away at wood using Dremel then you'd be all too familiar with the constant ringing in your ears that sticks around for hours after you're done. And that's not it, with a Dremel you have to be careful with the amount of load you run it under, too much and the motor will burn out. Proxxon's drills use wave controlled motors are capable of maintaining constant levels of torque at low speeds so making finishing touches in a precise manner shouldn't take as much effort as it does with the Dremel. Lastly, the darn thing is German made! If you've ever bothered with trying out different tools without buying the cheapest one off the shelf then you'd know German made tools are known for their superior build quality and rigid QC. The only caveat is that they're a little expensive compared to other tools, so in all likelihood, it seems I'll be getting a new drill/grinder in a month or so. Availability seems to be a problem.

Another reason why my DIY projects have taken a back seat is because of my soldering iron. As I've moved away from

through-hole components and started fiddling with SMT components, the need for a refined iron has never been more pressing. Especially, since I've managed to burn a few transistors with my 50 W iron by not following the temperature curve or rather being unable to do the same since you can only turn the iron on or off. So I started looking for soldering irons with variable temperature. And it wasn't long before two particular brands came to my attention – Hakko and Weller. One's German and the other Japanese, and they both have excellent offerings with quite the fan following. The Hakko FX-888D is a 70 W variable iron that can go from 50 - 480 degrees celsius. While the Weller WES51 is a 50 W iron that goes from 175 - 450 degrees celsius. Both of these temperature ranges are more than capable of handling situations that most hobbyists like me are bound to come across. The Hakko happens to have a digital temperature counter while the Weller sports an analog dial, however, this wasn't the deciding factor between the two either. In the end it came down to availability of replacement parts and Hakko seems to have won my heart in this aspect as I don't want to spend another decade resorting to jugaad to get my work done for me. 